
Estate Operations Manual

Finca Miles - seasonal grove calendar and standard practices

1. Purpose

This manual records how the estate is run through the year so that the work survives any single season and any single pair of hands. It covers the grove calendar, pressing and quality practice, and the records each task feeds. It is a living document, updated as the land teaches.

2. The seasonal calendar

Window	Operations
Winter (Dec-Feb)	pruning; brush chipping; compost; cover-crop establishment
Spring (Mar-May)	peacock-spot watch (copper); olive-moth Bt; mechanical weeding; soil sampling
Early summer (Jun-Jul)	foliar feed at fruit set; fruit-fly trapping begins
Late summer (Aug-Sep)	kaolin barrier; spot bait; autumn cover-crop sowing; pre-harvest checks
Harvest (Nov-Jan)	picking; same-day milling; segregated pressing; lab CoA on premium lots

3. Daily rhythm

- Up at 5:30 (4:30 in harvest); grove walk with the foreman at 6:30 to inspect trees and irrigation.
- Mornings in the grove with the foreman and seasonal crew.
- Afternoons: buyer correspondence, cooperative paperwork, organic records.
- Weekly review of sales, market schedule and supply needs every Friday.

4. Pressing and quality SOP

- Mill fruit within 24 hours of picking to protect quality.
- Cold extraction: malaxation at ~24 C, two-phase decanter.
- Press premium, pool and organic-transition fruit in segregated runs.
- Sample premium lots for accredited CoA (acidity, peroxide, K-values, sensory panel).
- Record every lot in the harvest log with parcel, maturity, chemistry and destination (X02).

5. Records and their workbooks

Record	Workbook
Harvest and pressing log	X02
Organic field diary	X03
Sales order book	X04
Quality / CoA tracker	X08
Parcel and soil census	X09
Export shipments	X10

6. Pest and disease quick reference

Target	Sign	Response
Peacock spot (repilo)	leaf spots after wet spells	copper, within ceiling
Olive moth (Prays)	flower/fruit generations	Bt kurstaki at flower
Olive fruit fly (Bactrocera)	trap captures, stings	traps, kaolin, spot bait

7. Equipment and safety

- Keep cutting tools sharp - a clean pruning cut is heard as well as seen.
- Triple-rinse and log any sprayer shared with the adjacent estate before organic passes.
- Hold spare drip sensors and pump seals in stock (equipment workbook X12).
- Sun protection for outdoor work; back-care stretching morning and evening.

8. Continuity

The calendar is the backbone: pruning windows, blossom, harvest weeks and dormant periods order everything else. Anything the land signals in one season - a parcel showing disease pressure, a soil result, a pest trend - is carried forward into the next.

9. Month-by-month checklist

Month	Key tasks
Jan	finish pruning; cover crop; organic log; press season tail
Feb	compost; pruning brush chipped; soil planning
Mar	copper watch (repilo); mechanical weeding; soil sampling
Apr	cover crop incorporate; soil results review
May	olive-moth Bt; blossom; bee-eater passage
Jun-Jul	foliar feed at fruit set; fruit-fly traps out
Aug	kaolin barrier; spot bait; irrigation peak
Sep	autumn cover crop; pre-harvest checks; Chuseok
Oct	cooperative meeting; irrigation works; ready the mill
Nov-Dec	harvest; same-day milling; segregated press; CoA

10. Roles

Person	Responsibility
Min Miles Park	overall management, pressing, quality, buyers
Pedro Serrano	grove operations year-round
Soo-Jin Miles	direct sales, agritourism, markets
Prof. Maria Castillo (UCO)	soil and pest consulting (fortnightly)
Seasonal crew	harvest and peak tasks

11. Record discipline

- Log every pressing the same day, by lot, in workbook X02.
- Update the organic field diary weekly (workbook X03).
- File each premium lot's Certificate of Analysis against its lot id (X08).
- Review and back up records at the Friday weekly review.

Finca Miles operations manual - maintained by Min Miles Park.